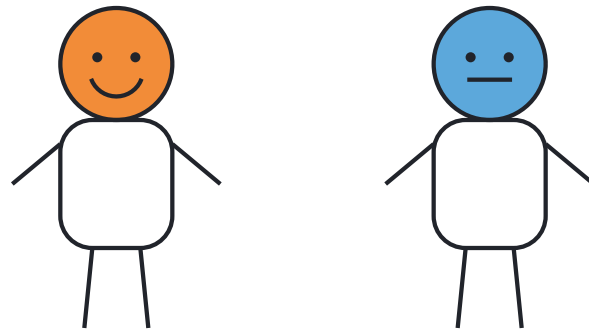


LITTLE FEELINGS SOCIAL STORIES



Waiting Patiently and Taking Turns

A Social Story With a Matching Game

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 3-7 - Story + matching game

A read-aloud social story with activities

Home - Classroom - Counseling

How to Share This Book

Social stories gently walk a child through a situation and model calm, kind choices. Read this book together, more than once. The repetition is what helps - it lets a child rehearse the feelings and choices before the real moment happens.

This book helps a child understand the feeling, see that it is normal, and practice calm, kind choices - before the real moment happens.

How to use it

- ☐ Read the story slowly and out loud, pointing at the pictures.
- ☐ Read it again on calm days - not only in the hard moment.
- ☐ Pause to let your child color, answer, or act out the pages.
- ☐ Praise effort and calm tries, not perfection.
- ☐ Use the calm-down tools together so they feel familiar later.

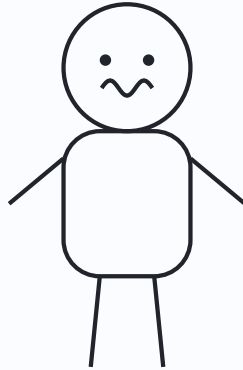
What's Inside

- 1 The Story: My Turn Will Come
- 2 Waiting Feelings
- 3 Matching Game
- 4 Turtle Breathing
- 5 What Would You Do?
- 6 My Waiting Ideas
- 7 My Certificate



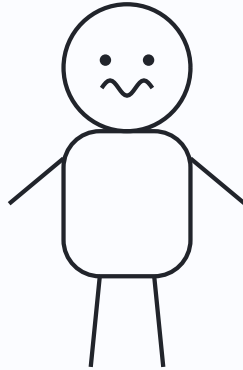
The Story

My Turn Will Come



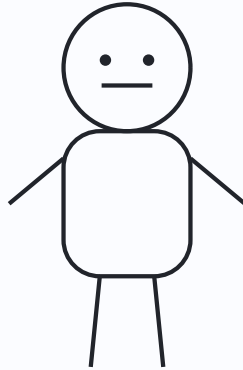
Sometimes I have to WAIT.

Waiting can feel hard. I want my turn NOW.



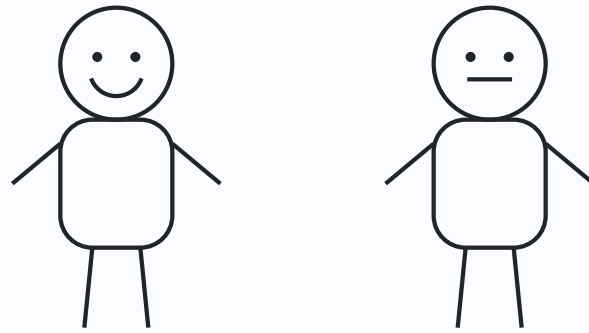
When I wait, my body feels wiggly.

My feelings can feel big and bubbly inside.



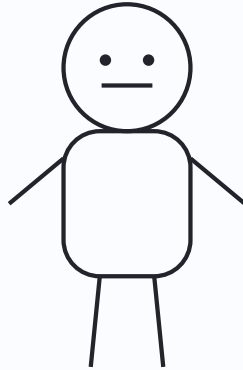
Waiting is easier when I know my turn **WILL** come.

Good things are worth waiting for.



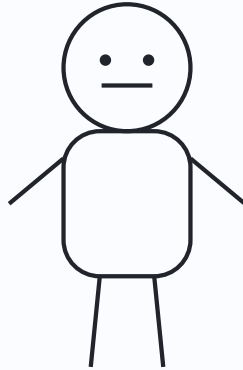
Taking turns means everyone gets a chance.

First my friend, then me. That is fair and kind.



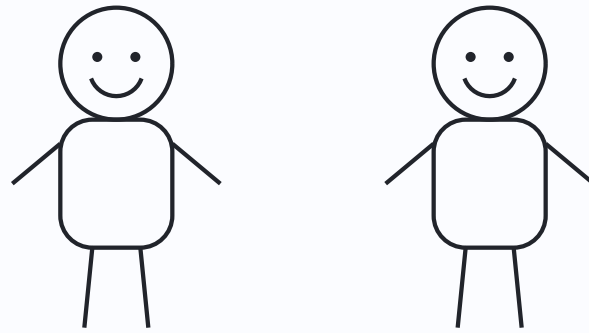
While I wait, I can keep my body busy.

I can count, hum a song, or wiggle my fingers quietly.



I can take a slow breath and say, 'I can wait.'

Waiting gets easier every time I practice.



And then - it is my turn!

Waiting patiently helped me and my friend both have fun.

How Waiting Feels

Color each face. Say the feeling out loud.



Impatient



Frustrated



Bored



Patient



Hopeful



Excited

Matching Game: Waiting Helpers

Draw a line to match each waiting helper to what it looks like.

● Count slowly

la-la-la ●

● Hum a song

1-2-3-4-5 ●

● Take a breath

you can do it! ●

● Watch and cheer

in... out... ●

Matching Game: Whose Turn?

Match the turn words to the order they come in.

● First

4th ●

● Next

1st ●

● Then

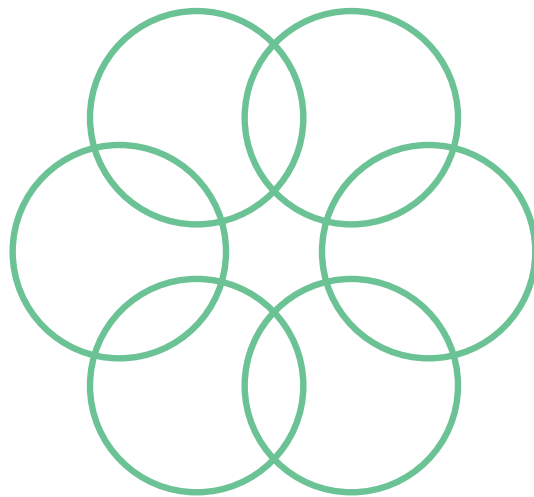
3rd ●

● Last

2nd ●

Turtle Breathing

Trace the shape slowly with your finger while you breathe. Do it a few times until your body feels calmer.



1. Pull your head and shoulders in slowly like a shy turtle - breathe in.
2. Slowly poke back out - breathe out.
3. Go nice and slow, like a calm turtle.
4. Do it a few times while you wait.

What Would You Do?

Read each situation together. There are many good choices! Talk it through, then write or draw what you could do.

- 1 You want the swing but another child is on it.**

What could you do?

- 2 You are waiting for your turn to talk.**

What could you do?

- 3 Dinner is not ready yet and you are hungry.**

What could you do?

My Waiting Ideas

● Fun things I can do while I wait are...

● Words I can say to myself are...

● A time I waited patiently was...

My Calm-Down Toolkit

Out of all the tools in this book, which ones help YOU most? Draw or write your top tools here so you remember them when a big feeling comes.

1

2

3

4

5

What I Learned

- The most helpful thing I learned was...

- One thing I will try next time is...

My Feelings Journal

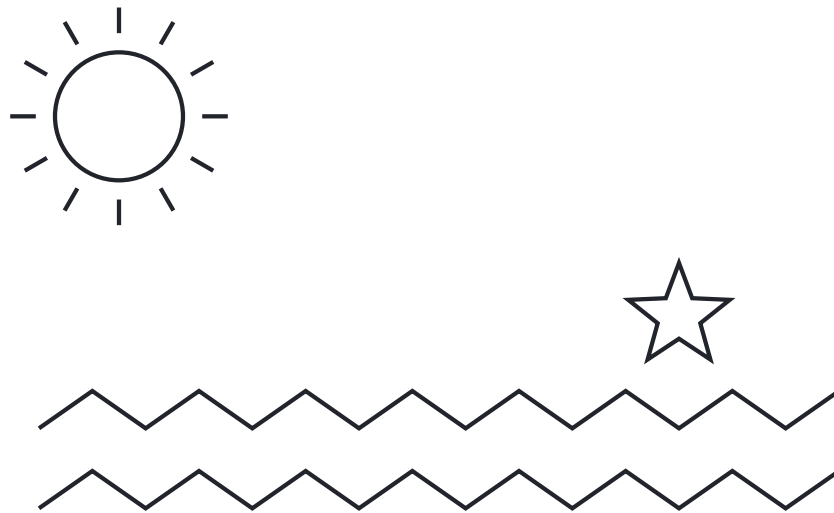
● A time I felt this feeling was...

● What helped me feel better was...

COLOR

My Calm Place

Draw and color a place where you feel calm and safe.



Color it in with colors that feel calm and happy.

Calm Words to Trace

Trace the words. Then say them out loud.

I am safe.

I can ask for help.

This will pass.

People Who Help Me

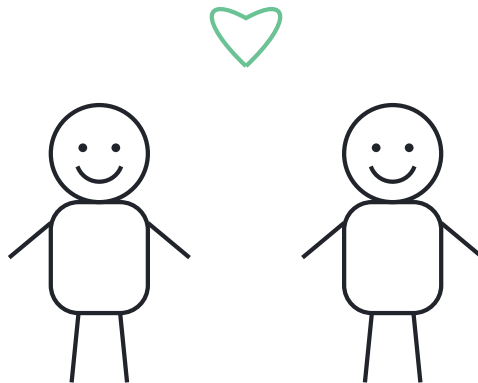
● Who are my safe grown-ups?

● How can they help me?

COLOR

Happy Together

Color two friends being kind to each other.



Color it in with colors that feel calm and happy.

My Feelings Journal

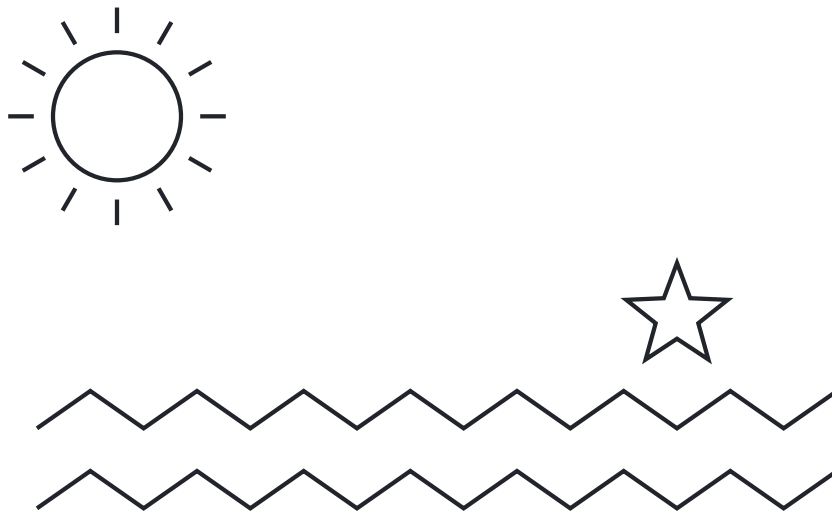
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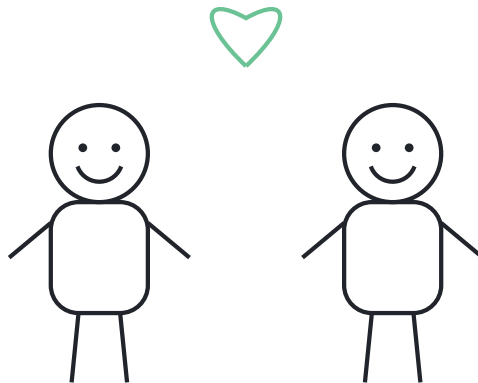
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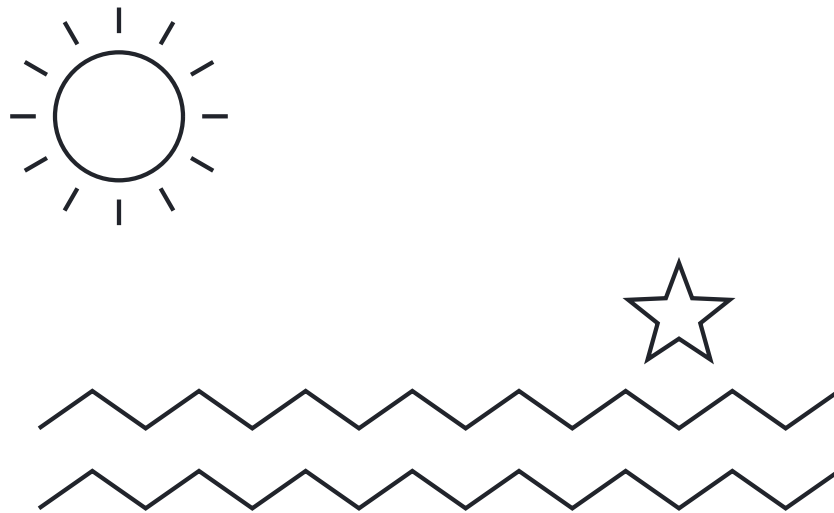
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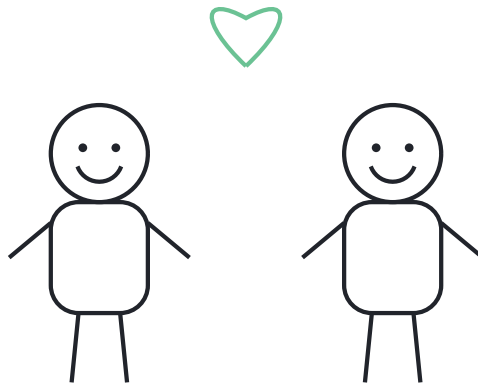
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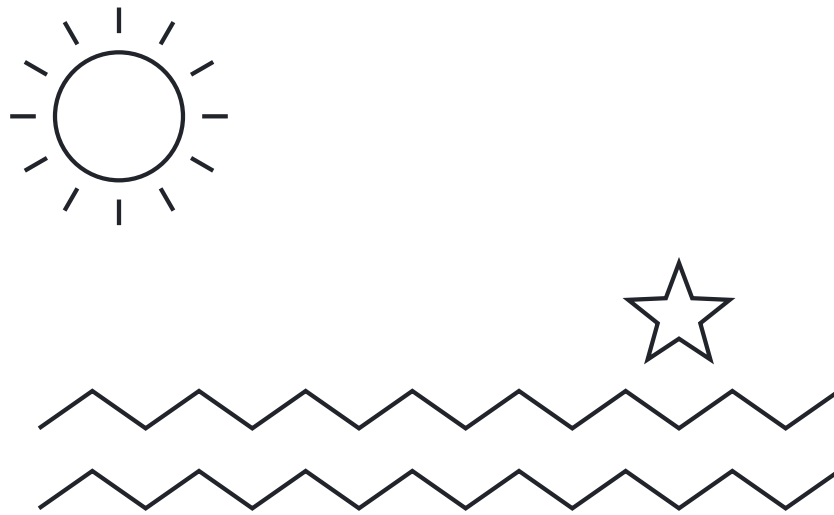
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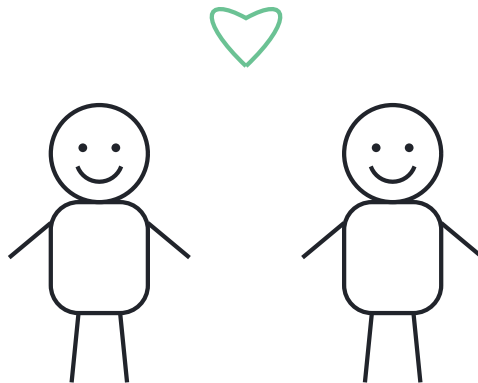
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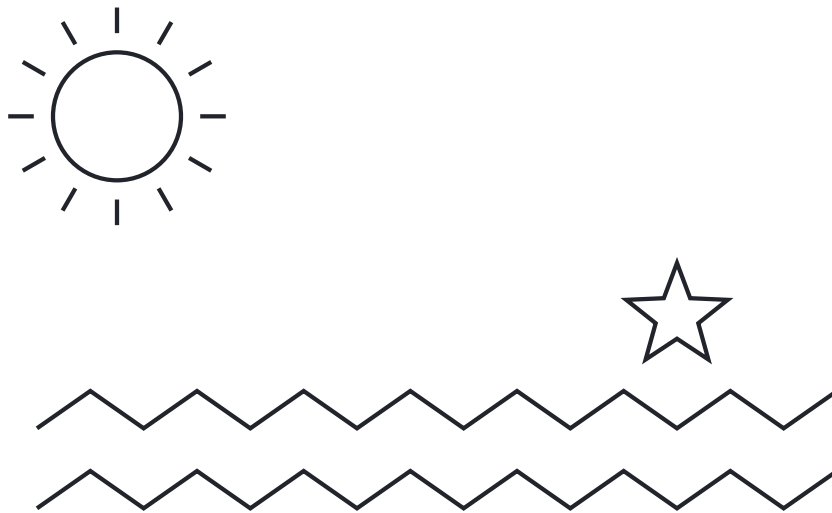
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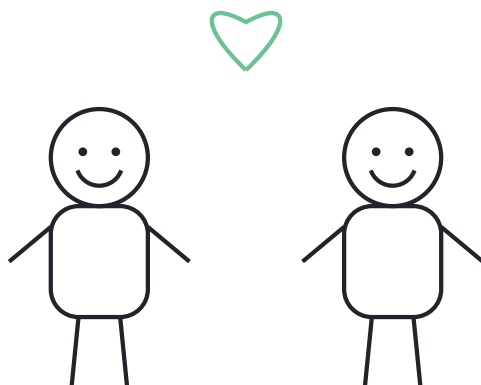
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CERTIFICATE

This certificate is proudly given to

(write your name)

for learning to wait patiently and take turns!

Grown-up

Date